

CYBER SECURITY INTERNSHIP REPORT

Task 7: Identify and Remove Suspicious Browser Extensions

Prepared for college submission

Department	Computer Science / Cyber Security
Academic Year	2025–2026
Tools Used	Google Chrome / Mozilla Firefox
Report Type	Task Completion Report

Description

Reviewed browser extensions to identify suspicious or unused add-ons, checked permissions and sources, removed unnecessary extensions, restarted the browser, and confirmed normal performance to improve security and safe browsing awareness.

Objective

To learn how to identify potentially harmful browser extensions, evaluate extension permissions, and remove unused or suspicious add-ons safely.

Reference Task Summary

The internship guide instructs learners to open the browser extension manager, review installed extensions, check permissions and reviews, remove suspicious or unnecessary extensions, restart the browser, and document the steps taken. It also emphasizes awareness of browser security risks and proper extension management.

Steps Performed

- Opened the browser extension manager from the settings menu.
- Reviewed all installed extensions one by one.
- Checked the permissions requested by each extension.
- Verified whether each extension was actively used and installed from a trusted source.
- Looked for suspicious indicators such as unnecessary permissions, unknown publisher, poor reviews, or inactivity.
- Removed extensions that were unused or unnecessary.
- Restarted the browser after cleanup.
- Confirmed that the browser continued to work normally after restart.

Observations

- Browser extensions may request powerful permissions such as access to all websites or reading browsing activity.
- Unused extensions can increase attack surface and may affect browser performance.
- Extensions should be installed only from trusted publishers and reviewed regularly.

Result

The browser extensions were reviewed successfully. Unused or unnecessary extensions were identified and removed where required. After restarting the browser, normal performance was confirmed. This task improved understanding of extension permissions, browser security risks, and safe browsing practices.

Key Concepts Learned

Concept	Importance
Browser security	Protects users from unsafe activity and data theft.
Extension permissions	Helps identify risky levels of access.
Malicious add-ons	Shows how harmful extensions can steal data or inject ads.
Safe installation practices	Encourages use of trusted sources and verified reviews.
Routine extension review	Reduces risk by removing unused tools.

Conclusion

Regularly reviewing browser extensions is an important cybersecurity practice. Removing suspicious or unused extensions reduces risk, improves browser hygiene, and builds awareness of how permissions can affect privacy and security.

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